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# SAFETY ALERT

OISD/SA/2024-25/P&E/08 12/2/2025

**INTRODUCTION**

Title: Fatal Incident of Truck Driver.

Location: Vicinity of molten sulphur loading area.

Loss/ Outcome: Fatality.

**BRIEF OF INCIDENT:**

A molten sulphur truck, engaged by private transporter to transport molten sulphur from Refinery to nearby industrial complex, entered refinery gate around 12:36 hrs after issuance of entry pass. The truck driver, aged 47 yrs, drove the truck for taking unladen weight to the weigh bridge. Subsequently, the truck reported at BS-VI SRU north sulphur loading bay. The loading started at 14:58 hrs and completed at 15:20 hrs. Around ~31MT of product was loaded.

After loading at 15:27 hrs, the truck left the loading bay area towards the Weigh Bridge for Laden weighment. Subsequently after about 8 minutes, a contract worker noticed that the driver lying on the road beside his truck, around 100 meters from the loading area. He immediately informed the SRU molten sulphur loading crew.

The loading service assistance contract personnel, who were present in the molten sulphur loading bay at that time, reached the spot and found that the driver had sustained head injury. The service assistance personnel reached the unit plant communicating system and informed BS-VI SRU's control room. The Panel-In-Charge alerted the Shift-In-Charge & Field Operator, who then rushed to the site. Meanwhile, Panel-In-Charge also informed Occupational Health Centre (OHC) about the incident and location.

Ambulance rushed to the site & the injured truck driver was shifted to OHC around 15.45 hrs. At OHC he was given first aid by Medical Officer and shifted to Government Hospital. The driver was declared brain dead after about 50 hrs.

**OBSERVATIONS / LAPSES**

1. The place where the truck was found parked, at a roadside location, was not a designated parking area.
2. The helper of the truck was not present along with the truck driver at the time of incident.
3. The truck loading lid and dip lid were found in closed condition (Refer Fig:1). This was noticed and reported by the molten sulphur truck loading service assistance worker. Hence, the possibility of driver becoming unconscious due to the presence of H2S was less.
4. The reading of 2 H2S detectors in the loading area was Zero PPM. No alarms for H2S presence was triggered in the gas detector at the loading bay or in any other part of the area before or during the loading of the truck.
5. Lab results taken two days before the incident shows NIL PPM of H2S. H2S value was checked through handheld meter, and it showed zero. Gas detector healthiness was also checked and found working.
6. The driver had PPEs like helmet and shoes. However, he was not wearing PPEs at the time of incident.

7. Display board, indicating Dos and Don’ts with respect to loading operation of molten sulphur, was not available at loading bay.
8. A proper truck wheel stopper was not available at loading bay. Temporary arrangements were used.

**Fig:1 – Top View of Molten Sulphur Tank Truck**

## CONCLUSION / ROOT CAUSE

The most probable cause could be fall from the top of truck while the driver was trying to either climb up or climb down the ladder attached to the truck. (Post-mortem report was still awaited at the time of publishing the safety alert.)

## RECOMMENDATIONS

1. All personnel engaged in loading/ unloading operations shall be given periodic training as per OISD-STD-154.
2. The truck cleaner should accompany the driver while plying inside the refinery premises.
3. Truck crew shall be instructed not to stop at undesignated areas.
4. Proper PPEs should be worn by the truck crew for the entire period within the refinery premises, whenever the driver is alighting the vehicle.
5. A checklist system shall be implemented to ensure all the safety measures before and after loading trucks.
6. Coverage of CCTV should be reviewed. Further, monitoring of critical activities through CCTV with adequate recording facility should be reviewed. Scrutiny of the footage, manually or through AI techniques, should be explored to identify unsafe acts/ conditions and take rectification measures thereof.
7. Display board indicating Dos and Don’ts with respect to loading operation of molten sulphur to be provided at loading location. Additional caution boards to be provided indicating restricted entry zone.
8. Fire & Safety shall also be intimated for any incident in addition to informing OHC.
9. Proper Truck wheel Stopper shall be provided at loading bay.

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